



Why can't Chimps speak?

Even though Chimps are really smart, you might have thought why they couldn't speak. Watch this to find out. <http://dgit.in/ChimpsSpeaking>



Light behaving like a crystal

Researchers at Princeton were able to make light behave as a crystal-like structure on a computer chip <http://dgit.in/LightCrystal>

Bazaar

Motorola Moto G 2nd Gen

Reminds us of a time gone by

If you look at the Moto G (2nd Gen) on Flipkart and read the specifications, you'll wonder why Motorola launched this device. This is something you realise only after you have the phone in your hand. In fact, this is something that I said in my first impressions of the device as well. The new Moto G is better than the older version. While more changes would have been welcome, but Motorola seems to have gone with the safer proposition to keep the price lower.

The new Moto G has a 5 inch display along with the same polycarbonate back that the original had. The phone looks like a larger version of the original, but Motorola has made this phone slimmer. In fact, the new Moto G is almost like a larger version of the original Moto X, except it doesn't perform like the Moto X. In addition, it also has thinner bezels, which cuts down on the size. The device could easily have been a lot bigger and cumbersome to use, but the new Moto G is quite comfortable in the hand and in the pocket.

Also, as before, the curved back gives better grip on the smartphone and makes the design more ergonomical. The build quality overall is impeccable and the white version of the Moto G looks quite good and seems very sturdy.

The 720p HD display on the new Moto G is actually its biggest weakness. While the Corning Gorilla Glass 3 protection does its job and makes the screen stronger and more premium, it is not the brightest screen you will find. What even more surprising though was the bad sunlight visibility on the new Moto G. The older version wasn't the best either, but it was better than the current version.

The good thing about the screen though is the extra real estate. It is large and makes for good video viewing. That is, unless you're watching videos with your friends, because the viewing angles aren't the best either. Motorola wasn't expected to put a full HD screen on this one, but we didn't see this coming.



Price
₹12,999

The new version of the Moto G runs on the same 1.2 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 400 quad-core SoC and 1 GB of RAM as the older generation. It also has the Adreno 305 GPU and continues the good performance that Motorola gave in the older one. Before you ask, yes, it doesn't compare to the Xiaomi Mi3, which has a much higher Snapdragon 800 SoC and 2 GB RAM.

The Moto G though doesn't disappoint in terms of the performance that you get out of it. The UI doesn't show any lags and resource intensive games like Asphalt 8 and others run quite smoothly on it. There were also no app crashes on the device, be it games or other apps.

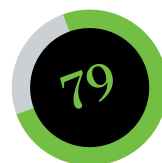
One thing we really wanted for the new device though was a bigger battery. The company went with the same 2070 mAh battery on this as the old one. Even though it doesn't disappoint and we got 10-12 hours out of it quite easily, one wonders if a bigger battery wouldn't have made the buying decision much easier.

One of the upgrades on the new Moto G is the 8 MP camera on the back, as opposed to the 5 MP on the older one. There is also a 2 MP front camera for selfies, video chats etc. Like the old camera though, the rear camera on this one is average. While the 8 MP sensor is better than the old one, it is definitely not the best camera on a smartphone in this range.

The new Moto G upholds Motorola's tradition of providing good value for the price that is being asked. The company beat the old price by Rs. 1000 and frankly, it had to. The new Moto G is a performer and a good phone to buy for Rs. 12,999 but the competition now is much tougher than it was with the last one.

For the brand conscious, you can still buy this phone, but it is no longer the best in class. The Xiaomi Mi3 remains the best in class right now, while the Micromax Canvas Nitro comes in at a close second. What the Moto G has over these two devices is history and brand recognition.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Screen: 5-inch IPS LCD;
Resolution: 1280x720;
SoC: Quad-core 1.2 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 400; **RAM:** 1GB; **GPU:** Adreno 305; **Storage:** 16GB;
Camera: 8MP rear, 2MP front; **Weight:** 149 gm;
Battery: 2070mAh; **OS:** Android 4.4.4

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